

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 37

The Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l

1. A recap of the Harf

In Arabic grammar the *Harf* is one of the three categories of the *Kalimah*. A *Harf* is a meaningful word, yet for its meaning and for the sense to become clear it must be joined to a noun or a verb.

The characteristics of the Harf

- All *huroof* are *Mabni*.
- The *huroof* have no inflected forms, as nouns and verbs do.
- Among the *huroof* there is no division into *Ma'rifah* and *Nakirah* as there is among nouns.
- Some *huroof* affect the *l'raab* of a noun and others that of a verb.
- In sentences the *huroof* sometimes come before the *Mubtada* and sometimes at the very end.

The kinds of Harf

Kind	Definition
Huroof Ghayr 'Amilah	if they come before a noun or a verb they bring no change to its <i>l'raab</i> ; the vowel of the final letter does not alter
Huroof 'Amilah fil Fi'l	coming before a verb, they make its final vowel <i>Mansoob</i> or <i>Majzoom</i>
Huroof 'Amilah fil Ism	coming before a noun, they make its final vowel <i>Mansoob</i> or <i>Majroor</i>

2. The Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l

Definition: In Arabic there are **six particles** that enter a *Jumla Ismiyyah* and carry its *Mubtada* into the state of *nasb*, while the *Khabar* remains in its original state of *raf'*. They are called the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l* or **إِنَّ وَأَخَوَاتُهَا**.

Their four names

Name	Reason for the name
Huroof Nasibah	because they give nasb to their noun
Huroof Nasikhah	because they change the I'raab of the Jumla Ismiyyah, that is, of the Muftada and the Khabar
Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l	on account of their resemblance to the verb
Akhawat, the sisters	being reckoned feminine, they are called the sisters of إِنَّ

The six particles at a glance

Particle	Meaning	Purpose	Qur'anic example
إِنَّ	indeed	produces the sense of emphasis in a Jumla Ismiyyah, so that the Khabar becomes free of doubt	إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَفِي خُسْرٍ
أَنَّ	that, indeed that	brought to take a clause into the interpretation of a single word	وَأَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَزِيزٌ حَمِيدٌ
كَأَنَّ	as though	brought for likeness	كَأَنَّهُنَّ الْيَاقُوتُ
لَيْتَ	if only	comes to express longing for something	لَيْتَنِي كُنْتُ تُرَابًا
لَكِنَّ	but	for istidrak, to remove a misapprehension arising from what preceded	لَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ
لَعَلَّ	perhaps, so that	for tarajji, hope, and ishfaq, apprehension	لَعَلَّ اللَّهَ يُحْدِثُ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ أَمْرًا

3. Three reasons for the resemblance to the verb

These particles resemble the verb both in wording and in meaning. It is for this that they are called the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l*.

Resemblance	Details
In wording	just as a verb is of three or of four letters, so some of these are of three letters — لَيْتَ and إِنَّ , أَنَّ — and some of four — لَعَلَّ and كَانَ , لَكِنَّ —
In working	just as transitive verbs require two things, a doer and an object, so the Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l require two things, a noun and a Khabar
In meaning	in each one of them the sense of some verb is found

The resemblance in meaning, in detail

Particle	The verb whose sense it holds	Meaning
إِنَّ and أَنَّ	تَحَقَّقَ ، أَكَّدَ	to be certain, and to emphasise
كَانَ	نَشَبَ	to be like
لَكِنَّ	إِسْتَدْرَكَ	to remove a misapprehension from what preceded
لَيْتَ	تَمَنَّى	to long for
لَعَلَّ	تَرَجَّى	to hope

4. The particle Inna

Among the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l* the one used most in the Qur'an is **إِنَّ**. It comes essentially at the head of a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, and it has no grammatical link with the sentence before it; rather, it begins a new and independent sentence.

Its purpose: Its basic purpose is to produce a powerful sense of emphasis in the sentence, by which every kind of doubt in the mind of the listener is removed and the *Khabar* becomes decisive and certain.

To make that emphasis firmer and more effective, the *Lam ut Ta'keed* is often used along with **إِنَّ**.

The verse	Translation
إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِفِي خُسْرٍ	indeed man is certainly in loss

The verse	Translation
إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَاسِعٌ عَلِيمٌ	indeed Allah is all-encompassing, all-knowing
إِنَّ الشِّرْكَ لَظُلْمٌ عَظِيمٌ	indeed associating partners is certainly a great wrong
إِنَّ بَطْشَ رَبِّكَ لَشَدِيدٌ	indeed the grip of your Lord is certainly severe

5. The particle Anna

The particle **أَنَّ** is used, like **إِنَّ**, to produce emphasis and certainty in a *Jumla Ismiyyah*. Yet there is an important grammatical difference in where the two are placed.

The basic difference: **أَنَّ** never comes at the head of the speech; it always falls within the sentence.

The reason is that it takes the clause following it into *ta'weel mufrad* — that is, it makes the whole clause stand in the place of a single word or verbal noun. This is why, instead of remaining an independent sentence, it joins with the words after it to become the *Fa'il*, the *Maf'ool bihi*, or the *majroor* of a *Harf ul Jarr* belonging to the preceding sentence, and so becomes a necessary part of it, producing connection in the speech.

Four Qur'anic examples

أَوَلَمْ يَكْفِهِمْ أَنَّا أَنزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ

(Surah al-'Ankabut: 51)

Translation: Is it not sufficient for them that We revealed to you the Book?

أَنَا joins with the clause after it to become the *Fa'il* of the verb **يَكْفِهِمْ**.

أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 106)

Translation: Do you not know that Allah is over all things competent?

أَنَّ joins with its noun and its Khabar, stands in *ta'weel mufrad*, and becomes the *Maf'ool bihi* of the preceding verb **تَعْلَمْ**.

لِيَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ وَعْدَ اللَّهِ حَقٌّ

(Surah al-Kahf: 21)

Translation: So that they might know that the promise of Allah is true.

The whole group falls as the *Maf'ool bihi* of **لِيَعْلَمُوا**.

ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الْحَقُّ

(Surah Luqman: 30)

Translation: That is because Allah is the Truth.

On account of the *Harf ul Jarr* **بِ**, this whole emphatic clause stands in the state of *jarr*, that is, as *majroor*, and becomes a part of the preceding speech.

6. The particle Ka-anna

This particle is a compound of **كَ**, the *Harf ul Jarr* of likeness, and **أَنَّ**. Within it lies an emphatic content of likeness.

It is used to declare one thing to be like another, but the likeness it conveys is stronger and firmer than that of the plain **كَ**.

زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ ← كَانَ زَيْدًا أَسَدٌ

(Zayd is a lion → as though Zayd were a lion)

The basic difference between Ka and Ka-anna: The **كَ** of likeness enters upon the *mushabbah bihi*, the thing likened to, as in زَيْدٌ كَأَلَسَدِ — here Zayd is the *mushabbah* and the lion the *mushabbah bihi*. Whereas **كَانَ** enters upon the *mushabbah*, as in كَانَ زَيْدًا أَسَدٌ.

A Qur'anic example

كَانَ فِي أُذُنَيْهِ وَقْرًا

(Surah Luqman: 7)

Translation: As though there were a deafness in his two ears.

Element	Details
كَانَ	a Harf Mushabbah bil Fi'l
فِي أُذُنَيْهِ	the Khabar Muqaddam — the jarr and its majroor together form a Murakkab Jarri, and since a jarr with its majroor cannot be the Muftada in a Jumla Ismiyyah, this is the Khabar brought forward
وَقْرًا	the Ism Mu'akhkhar — it is Mansoob, being the noun of كَانَ

7. The particle Lakinna

لَكِنَّ is brought essentially for *istidrak*, whose purpose, like the English "but", is to remove any possible misapprehension, doubt or misunderstanding arising from what was said before.

In point of style it is sometimes used in the form وَلَكِنَّ, where the waw at its head is one of circumstance or of parenthesis.

Being one of the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l*, it gives the state of *nasb* to the noun that follows it.

الْإِسْلَامُ حَقٌّ لَكِنَّ الْكُفَّارَ جَاهِدُونَ

(Islam is the truth, but the disbelievers persist in obstinacy and ignorance)

In this sentence لَكِنَّ entered the noun after it, الْكُفَّارَ, and made it *Mansoob*, which not only removed the ambiguity of what preceded but also produced eloquence and firmness of meaning in the speech.

Qur'anic examples

The verse	Translation
وَلَكِنَّ الْمُنَافِقِينَ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ	but the hypocrites do not know
وَمَا كَفَرَ سُلَيْمَنُ وَلَكِنَّ الشَّيَاطِينَ كَفَرُوا	and Sulayman did not disbelieve, but the devils disbelieved
وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَهُمْ لَا يَشْكُرُونَ	but most of them are not grateful

8. The particle Layta

لَيْتَ is used essentially for *tamannee* — longing, wishing and regret.

A rhetorical point: It is generally used for matters that are keenly desired but little expected to come about, or that are by nature difficult, remote, or sometimes altogether impossible. For that reason لَيْتَ is not a mere expression of wish; it often carries within it the senses of **regret, remorse, sorrow and inward anguish** as well.

لَيْتَ زَيْدًا حَاضِرٌ

(if only Zayd were present)

Here زَيْدًا is *Mansoob* for being the noun of لَيْتَ, while حَاضِرٌ is its *Khabar* and *Marfoo'*.

Qur'anic examples

The verse	Translation
يَلَيْتَنِي كُنْتُ مَعَهُمْ فَأَفُوزَ فَوْزًا عَظِيمًا	if only I had been with them, then I would have attained a great triumph
وَيَقُولُ الْكَافِرُ يَلَيْتَنِي كُنْتُ تُرَابًا	and the disbeliever will say: if only I were dust
قَالَ يَلَيْتَ قَوْمِي يَعْلَمُونَ	he said: if only my people knew
يَلَيْتَهَا كَانَتِ الْقَاضِيَةَ	if only it had been the decisive one
يَلَيْتَ لَنَا مِثْلَ مَا أُوتِيَ قَارُونُ	if only we had the like of what Qarun was given

A marked style: A marked feature of لَيْتَ in the Qur'an is that it is often used with attached pronouns, which become its noun — as in يَلَيْتَنِي and يَلَيْتَنَا.

9. The particle La'alla

لَعَلَّ is a *Harf Nasikh* that gives *nasb* to its noun and *raf'* to its *Khabar*. Its basic sense is **expectation** — expressing hope or apprehension that something will come about. For this it is also called the *Harf ut Tawaqqu'*.

The two forms of expectation

Form	When?	Example
Tarajji (hope)	hoping for something liked and good	لَعَلَّ زَيْدًا بِخَيْرٍ (it is hoped Zayd is well)
Ishfaq (apprehension)	expressing fear or apprehension of something disliked	لَعَلَّ زَيْدًا مَرِيضٌ (perhaps Zayd is ill)

A most important point: If لَعَلَّ is ascribed to Allah, then "perhaps" is **not** its real sense there; rather it carries the meaning of **certainty, decisiveness or wisdom** — for in the knowledge of Allah there is no doubt. And if لَعَلَّ comes from a created being, its sense there will be hope, expectation or apprehension.

وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 189)

Translation: And fear Allah, so that you may be successful.

Here the sense of لَعَلَّ is the expectation of success, that is, holding out the hope of it.

10. The rulings on the noun and the Khabar

When the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l* enter a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, the former standing of the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* changes. The *Mubtada* is now called the *Ism Harf Mushabbah bil Fi'l*, and the *Khabar* the *Khabar Harf Mushabbah bil Fi'l*. These particles make their noun *Mansoob* and keep the *Khabar Marfoo'*.

An important difference: Most of the rulings on the noun and the *Khabar* are the same as those on the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar*. One important difference, however, is that **bringing the Khabar before the noun is generally not permitted**, because these particles establish a particular bond between their noun and their *Khabar*.

One exception, however: If the *Khabar* is a *zarf* or a *jarr* with its *majroor*, bringing it before the noun is permitted, and it is much used in Arabic style.

إِنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا

(Surah ash-Sharh: 6)

Translation: Indeed with hardship comes ease.

Here مَعَ الْعُسْرِ is the *Khabar* of إِنَّ, being a *zarf*, and it has come before the noun يُسْرًا.

إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَعِبْرَةً

(Surah an-Nazi'at: 26)

Translation: Indeed in that is certainly a lesson.

In this verse the *jarr* with its *majroor* فِي ذَلِكَ is the *Khabar* of إِنَّ, brought before the noun لَعِبْرَةً.

11. The Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l with the Dama'ir

When attached pronouns enter the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l*, those pronouns become the *Mansoob* noun of the particle. Since these pronouns are *Ma'rifah* and *Mabni*, they are grammatically reckoned to be *fee mahalli nasb* — in the position of *nasb*.

With Inna

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	إِنَّهُ	إِنَّهُمَا	إِنَّهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	إِنَّهَا	إِنَّهُمَا	إِنَّهِنَّ
Mudhakkar Hadir	إِنَّكَ	إِنَّكُمَا	إِنَّكُمْ
Mu'annath Hadir	إِنَّكِ	إِنَّكُمَا	إِنَّكُنَّ
Mutakallim	إِنِّي / إِنِّي	—	إِنَّا / إِنَّا

With Anna

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	أَنَّه	أَنَّهَما	أَنَّهم
Mu'annath Gha'ib	أَنَّها	أَنَّهَما	أَنَّهنَّ
Mudhakkar Hadir	أَنَّكَ	أَنَّكُما	أَنَّكُمْ
Mu'annath Hadir	أَنَّكِ	أَنَّكُما	أَنَّكُنَّ
Mutakallim	أَنِّي / أَنِّي	—	أَنَّا / أَنَّا

With Ka-anna

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	كَأَنَّهُ	كَأَنَّهُمَا	كَأَنَّهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	كَأَنَّهَا	كَأَنَّهُمَا	كَأَنَّهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Hadir	كَأَنَّكَ	كَأَنَّكُما	كَأَنَّكُمْ
Mu'annath Hadir	كَأَنَّكِ	كَأَنَّكُما	كَأَنَّكُنَّ
Mutakallim	كَأَنِّي / كَأَنِّي	—	كَأَنَّا / كَأَنَّا

With Lakinna

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	لِكِنَّهُ	لِكِنَّهُمَا	لِكِنَّهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	لِكِنَّهَا	لِكِنَّهُمَا	لِكِنَّهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Hadir	لِكِنَّكَ	لِكِنَّكُمَا	لِكِنَّكُمْ
Mu'annath Hadir	لِكِنَّكِ	لِكِنَّكُمَا	لِكِنَّكُنَّ
Mutakallim	لِكِنِّي / لِكَيْ	—	لِكِنَّا / لِكِنَّا

With Layta

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	لَيْتَهُ	لَيْتَهُمَا	لَيْتَهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	لَيْتَهَا	لَيْتَهُمَا	لَيْتَهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Hadir	لَيْتَكَ	لَيْتَكُمَا	لَيْتَكُمْ
Mu'annath Hadir	لَيْتَكِ	لَيْتَكُمَا	لَيْتَكُنَّ
Mutakallim	لَيْتَنِي	—	لَيْتَنَا

With La'alla

Form	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar Gha'ib	لَعَلَّهُ	لَعَلَّهُمَا	لَعَلَّهُمْ
Mu'annath Gha'ib	لَعَلَّهَا	لَعَلَّهُمَا	لَعَلَّهُنَّ
Mudhakkar Hadir	لَعَلَّكَ	لَعَلَّكُمَا	لَعَلَّكُمْ
Mu'annath Hadir	لَعَلَّكِ	لَعَلَّكُمَا	لَعَلَّكُنَّ
Mutakallim	لَعَلِّي	—	لَعَلَّنَا

12. The three rulings on the Nun ul Wiqayah

Where the pronoun is the singular *Mutakallim*, a noon is generally placed between the noun and the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim*, which is called the *Nun ul Wiqayah*. With these six particles it has three different rulings.

Ruling	With which particles	The forms
Jawaz (bringing it or leaving it — both sound)	إِنَّ ، أَنَّ ، كَأَنَّ ، لَكِنَّ	أَنْتِي or إِيْ . أَنْتِي or أَيْ . كَأَنْتِي or كَأَيْ . لَكِنَّتِي or لَكَيْ
Wujoob (bringing it is obligatory)	لَيْتَ	لَيْتَتِي saying لَيْتِي is wrong
Imtina' (it generally does not come)	لَعَلَّ	لَعَلِّي لَعَلِّي is not said

Qur'anic examples with attached pronouns

The verse	Translation
إِنَّهُ لَكُمْ عَدُوٌّ مُّبِينٌ	indeed he is a manifest enemy to you
يَعْلَمُونَ أَنَّهُ مُنَزَّلٌ مِّن رَّبِّكَ بِالْحَقِّ	they know that it is sent down from your Lord with the truth
كَأَنَّهُنَّ الْيَاقُوتُ وَالْمَرْجَانُ	as though they were rubies and coral
طَلَعَهَا كَأَنَّهُ رُءُوسُ الشَّيَاطِينِ	its emerging fruit as though it were the heads of devils
كَأَنَّهُا كَوْكَبٌ دُرِّيٌّ	as though it were a brilliant star
كَأَنَّهُمْ خُشْبٌ مُّسْنَدَةٌ	as though they were propped-up timber
يَلَيَّتَنِي كُنْتُ تُرَابًا	if only I were dust
يَلَيَّتَهَا كَانَتِ الْقَاضِيَةَ	if only it had been the decisive one
وَلَكِنَّهُ أَخْلَدَ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ	but he clung to the earth
وَإِنْ أَدْرِي لَعَلَّهُ فِتْنَةٌ لَّكُمْ	and I do not know; perhaps it is a trial for you

13. Ma Kaffah

Sometimes a مَا is attached to the end of these particles, called in the terminology of grammar *Ma Kaffah* — the "restraining ma". When it joins them it does two great things.

What it does	Details
It ends their grammatical effect	it altogether removes the power of these particles to work. They can no longer give nasb to the noun after them, and the sentence returns to its original state as a Mubtada and a Khabar
It permits entry upon a Jumla Fi'liyyah	these particles essentially come only upon a Jumla Ismiyyah, but joined with Ma Kaffah they widen in scope and may be used with verbs as well

A further benefit: When these particles come with *Ma Kaffah* in a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, they give the sense of *Hasr* — that is, of confining the statement to one thing.

13.1 Innama — in a Jumla Ismiyyah

إِنَّمَا اللَّهُ إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ

(Surah an-Nisa: 171)

Translation: Allah is but one God.

Here مَا restrained the effect of إِنَّ, which is why the *Ism ul Jalalah* اللَّهُ has come *Marfoo'* for being the *Mubtada*, rather than *Mansoob*.

قَالُوا إِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مُصْلِحُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 11)

Translation: They say: we are only reformers.

On account of the *Ma Kaffah*, the grammatical working of إِنَّ ended here. That is why, instead of a *Mansoob* attached pronoun, the *Marfoo'* detached pronoun نَحْنُ has come, which is the *Mubtada*, and مُصْلِحُونَ is its *Khabar*. Had مَا not been between them, it would have been إِنَّا.

13.2 Annama

قُلْ إِنَّمَا يُوحِي إِلَيَّ أَنَّكُمْ إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ

(Surah al-Anbiya: 108)

Translation: Say: it is only revealed to me that your God is but one God.

Because the *Ma Kaffah* came with أَنَّ, its grammatical effect ended. Here إِنَّكُمْ is the *Mubtada* and إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ, a *Murakkab Tawsifi*, is its *Khabar*.

This ma did two things: First it restrained the grammatical effect of **أَنَّ**; and second it also ended that standing of verbal-noun interpretation which the noun and Khabar used to take under it.

13.3 Ka-annama — in a Jumla Fi'liyyah

كَأَنَّمَا يَصْعَدُ فِي السَّمَاءِ

(Surah al-An'am: 125)

Translation: As though he were climbing into the sky.

Here the **Ma Kaffah** attached to **كَأَنَّ** gave the particle the capacity to enter a **Jumla Fi'liyyah**. Accordingly the verb **يَصْعَدُ** has been used after it.

14. Lightening the noon — Mukhaffafah min al-Muthaqqalah

Four of the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'* carry a shaddah on the noon at their end: **لَنَّ ، كَنَّ ، اَنَّ ، اَنَّ**.

Definition: In Arabic, to make them lighter to read, the shaddah is removed and the noon made silent. In that state they are called *Mukhaffafah min al-Muthaqqalah* — "those lightened from the heavy". After this lightening they may enter a *Jumla Fi'liyyah* as well.

14.1 In Mukhaffafah

When **اَنَّ** is lightened and read as **اَنَّ**, it is permitted both to keep its grammatical effect and to end it.

قَالُوا اِنَّ هٰذَيْنِ لَسٰحِرٰنِ

(Surah Ta-Ha: 63)

Translation: They said: indeed these two are certainly magicians.

Here, on account of the lightening, the effect of **اَنَّ** has ended, which is why the *Marfoo' Ism ul Isharah* **هٰذَيْنِ** has been used rather than the *Mansoob* form **هٰذَيْنِ**.

A necessary condition: When the effect of **اَنَّ** *Mukhaffafah* is not kept, it becomes obligatory to bring a *Lam ut Ta'keed* upon its *Khabar* — as the lam in **لَسٰحِرٰنِ** — so that **اَنَّ** of negation may be told apart from **اَنَّ** *Mukhaffafah*.

14.2 An Mukhaffafah

When this particle is used in its lightened form with a noun, its grammatical effect **always remains**. But the noun upon which its effect falls is always a pronoun, and that pronoun does not appear in the wording; it is omitted.

وَآخِرُ دَعْوٰهُمْ اَنْ الْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَ

(Surah Yunus: 10)

Translation: And the last of their call will be: all praise is for Allah, Lord of all the worlds.

Originally this was **اِنَّهُ الْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَ**, where the pronoun **هُ** was the noun of **اَنَّ**, and it is now omitted.

14.3 Ka-an Mukhaffafah

When **كَانَ** is lightened to **كَانَ**, it too always keeps its grammatical effect. Like **اَنَّ**, its noun is likewise always a pronoun that does not appear in the wording but is omitted.

14.4 Lakin Mukhaffafah

This one differs from the rest: After lightening, لَكِنْ always becomes *Ghayr 'Amil* — that is, its grammatical effect does not remain in any case. The noun coming after it will always be found *Marfoo'*.

لَكِنَّ الرَّاْسِخُوْنَ فِي الْعِلْمِ مِنْهُمْ

(Surah an-Nisa: 162)

Translation: But those firmly grounded in knowledge among them.

يَوْمَ يَأْتُوْنََنَا لَكِنَّ الظَّالِمُوْنَ الْيَوْمَ فِي ضَلٰلٍ مُّبِيْنٍ

(Surah Maryam: 38)

Translation: The day they will come to Us — but the wrongdoers today are in manifest error.

In both verses the noun after لَكِنْ — الرَّاْسِخُوْنَ and الظَّالِمُوْنَ — has come in its original *Marfoo'* state with a waw, because the effect of the particle has ended.

Why the kasrah beneath the noon?: The kasrah seen beneath the noon in the verses is given only to join the silent noon to the word that follows. This is the same rule of *Ijtima' as-Sakinayn* that was covered in Lectures 27 and 28.

Summary

1. All huroof are Mabni, they have no inflected forms, and among them there is no division into Ma'rifah and Nakirah.
2. The huroof are of two kinds: Ghayr 'Amilah, which do not change the l'raab, and 'Amilah, which do.
3. The Huroof 'Amilah divide further into those working upon the verb and those working upon the noun.
4. In Arabic there are six particles that enter a Jumla Ismiyyah and make the Muftada Mansoob while the Khabar stays Marfoo'.
5. They are called by four names: Huroof Nasibah, Huroof Nasikhah, Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l, and Akhawat, the sisters.
6. The six particles are: لَيْتَ, إِنَّ, أَنْ, كَأَنَّ, لَكِنَّ, and لَعَلَّ.
7. They resemble the verb in three ways: in wording, in working, and in meaning.
8. The resemblance in wording is that some are of three letters — لَيْتَ and إِنَّ, أَنْ — and some of four — لَعَلَّ and كَأَنَّ, لَكِنَّ.
9. The resemblance in working is that, as transitive verbs require a doer and an object, so these require a noun and a Khabar.
10. The resemblance in meaning is that each holds the sense of some verb — certainty, likeness, correction, longing and hope.
11. إِنَّ is the particle most used in the Qur'an, and it always comes at the head of the sentence.
12. أَنْ never comes at the head of the speech but always within the sentence.
13. The reason is that it takes the clause after it into ta'weel mufrad, and then becomes the Fa'il, the Maf'ool bihi or the majroor of a Harf ul Jarr belonging to what precedes.
14. كَأَنَّ is a compound of كَ and أَنْ, and its likeness is stronger than that of the plain كَ.
15. The كَ of likeness enters upon the mushabbah bihi, while كَأَنَّ enters upon the mushabbah.
16. لَكِنَّ comes for istidrak, to remove a misapprehension arising from what preceded.
17. لَيْتَ comes for tamannee, and often holds the senses of regret, remorse and inward anguish as well.
18. لَعَلَّ is also called the Harf ut Tawaqqu'; tarajji for something liked and ishfaq for something disliked.
19. If لَعَلَّ is ascribed to Allah, the sense is not "perhaps" but certainty, decisiveness or wisdom.
20. Bringing the Khabar of these particles before the noun is generally not permitted, but it is permitted when the Khabar is a zarf or a jarr with its majroor.
21. إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَعِبْرَةً and إِنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا are examples of that exception.
22. When attached pronouns enter these particles they become their Mansoob noun, and being Mabni they are called fee mahalli nasb.
23. The Nun ul Wiqayah has three rulings: jawaz with the first four particles, wujoob with لَيْتَ, and imtina' with لَعَلَّ.
24. So لَعَلِّي is obligatory and لَعَلِّي is what is used, while لَعَلِّي is not said.

25. Ma Kaffah ends the grammatical effect of these particles and makes them fit to enter a Jumla Fi'liyyah.
26. With Ma Kaffah these particles give the sense of Hasr in a Jumla Ismiyyah.
27. In **إِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مُصْلِحُونَ** the Marfoo' detached pronoun **نَحْنُ** came, because ma restrained the effect of **إِنَّ**.
28. Removing the shaddah and making the noon silent is called lightening, and such particles are called Mukhaffafah min al-Muthaqqalah.
29. It is permitted both to keep and to end the effect of **إِنْ** Mukhaffafah, but where it is ended a Lam ut Ta'keed upon the Khabar becomes obligatory.
30. **أَنَّ** and **كَأَنَّ** Mukhaffafah always keep their effect, but their noun is always an omitted pronoun.
31. **لَيْكُنْ** Mukhaffafah always becomes Ghayr 'Amil after lightening, and the noun after it will always be Marfoo'.

Exercise

1. Write all five characteristics of the Harf.
2. Define both kinds of the Huroof 'Amilah.
3. Define the Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l and write all four of their names with the reason for each.
4. Set out the six particles with their meanings and purposes in a table.
5. Describe in detail all three reasons for their resemblance to the verb.
6. Which verb's sense lies under each particle in the resemblance of meaning?
7. What is the basic grammatical difference between **إِنَّ** and **أَنَّ**?
8. What is meant by ta'weel mufrad? Write all four Qur'anic examples of **أَنَّ** and state the part each plays.
9. Explain the difference between the **كَ** of likeness and **كَأَنَّ**.
10. Give a full analysis of **كَأَنَّ فِي أُذُنَيْهِ وَقُرْأَ**.
11. For what purpose does **لَيْكُنْ** come? Give three Qur'anic examples.
12. State the rhetorical aspects of **لَيْتَ**.
13. Write both forms of **لَعَلَّ** with examples.
14. What difference arises in the sense of **لَعَلَّ** when it is ascribed to Allah?
15. What is the ruling on bringing the Khabar of these particles forward, and what is the exception?
16. Write the complete conjugation with pronouns for any three of the six particles.
17. Write all three rulings of the Nun ul Wiqayah along with the particles.
18. What is Ma Kaffah and which two things does it do?
19. Why did **نَحْنُ** come in **إِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مُصْلِحُونَ**, and not **إِنَّا**?
20. Which work of Ma Kaffah is proved by **كَأَنَّمَا يَصَّعَّدُ فِي السَّمَاءِ**?
21. Define Mukhaffafah min al-Muthaqqalah and name all four particles.

22. Why is the Lam ut Ta'keed obligatory with إِنَّ Mukhaffafah?

23. In what way does لَكِنَّ Mukhaffafah differ from the other three?

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ